



MONKEY BUSINESS

News of The Funky Monkeys, Lynbrook High School Robotics, FIRST® Team 846



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Presidents' Welcome



Vyaas Baskar (sr.)

Kush Goel (sr.)

The ear-splitting shrieks of our robot's lift mechanism overpowered the commotion of a forty-nine-team event. Even louder were shouts of our team as we scrambled to resolve issues as fast as humanly possible. In the midst of the chaos at the Canadian Pacific Regional, we were innovating, problem-solving, and having the time of our lives!

Joining the team my freshman

see Vyaas's Welcome, page 4

When I first entered room 608 for my first worksession, I expected this team to be much different than what I now know it is. Coming onto the team, I expected a workplace environment with a "bunch of nerds" doing only one thing: working on robots. What I found was miles different. 846 was truly a team – everyone was familiar with each other after spending countless hours building robots. We

see Kush's Welcome, page 2

The Western Region Robotics Forum

Allison Chew (jr.) and Rhea Susarla (jr.)

As rookies on the Lynbrook Robotics team, we had no idea where to begin. When we heard about the 2024 Western Region Robotics Forum

(WRRF) Conference, we saw it as an opportunity to gain experience despite not knowing exactly what we were signing up for. Naturally, this led to many questions. First of all, what is WRRF?

The Western Region Robotics Forum is an annual conference organized to help

mentors and students on FRC teams expand their knowledge and build connections. In 2024, it was held at Santa Clara University. Throughout the day, various sessions covered topics ranging from technical skills to team strategies. Our team, 846, presents each year on the basics of robot subsystems.

see The Western Region Robotics Forum, page 3

Driver Life at the Capital City Classic

Amogh Rao (sr.)

Capital City Classic was our last competition of the 2024 season! Coming off as finalists the year before, we hoped to take the win this year. Held in Pleasant Grove, the event brought together 51 teams to compete in the 2024 First Robotics Competition game, Crescendo.

The competition kicked off Saturday morning with an electric

Qualification matches are

always a bundle of

anticipation and nervousness

atmosphere. As one of our two drivers, I was eager to put everything I'd learned from my first competition, Sunset Showdown, into practice. Personally, qualification matches are always a bundle of anticipation and nervousness. Each match presents an opportunity to improve ourselves and our team ranking, but also has the power to destroy our winning chances. Throughout the day, my partner and I focused on driving consistency. Driving the robot is as much about muscle memory as it is about strategy, and my job was to keep a cool head, listen to our drive coach's calls, and execute each maneuver as smoothly as possible. Between matches, we spent time in the pits fine-tuning and making fixes to our robot if necessary. Every tweak felt like an investment in our chances for success. We played 6 qualification matches on Saturday, but due to some poor luck combined with miscommunications, we won only 2. We headed back to our hotel with the hope of better results the next day.

Sunday started bright and early

Kush's Welcome, Continued...



Kush Goel (sr.) writing code for our robot.

joked around, ate dinners together, and bonded over our mutual anxious anticipation for our robot's turnout. And this culture isn't just specific to us. When I went to the Chezy Champs competition for the first time as a sophomore, the collaborative attitude from even the best teams surprised me. FRC was an environment that truly cultivated learning and innovation over all else – even over winning.

And as a Funky Monkey, I can proudly say that we do things differently. Whether it's deciding on a distinctive double lift robot concept or developing custom, in-house software routines over built-

in FRC functions, this team embraces being unique and special. When you join, bring your quirky ideas, speak up during design meetings about your silly robot concepts, and discuss strategies that the team hadn't even considered. Don't be afraid to join the conversation and provide your input, even if you feel afraid, because whatever you come up with, this team is definitely crazy enough to try it.

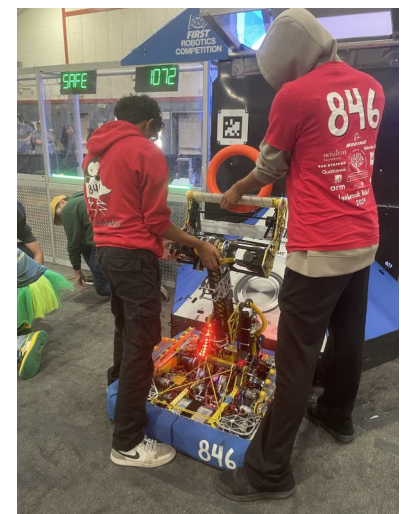
As I continue to meet you all, I hope you not only learn a lot in this journey but also make new friends on this team. Welcome to 846!



Kush Goel (sr.) testing a prototype robot shooter.



with the final 3 qualification matches. Knowing these were our last chances to prove ourselves, I tried to make every moment count on the field. The highlight of the competition was pulling off a "trap" scoring maneuver, where our robot climbed on a chain and precisely placed a game piece into the scoring slot. The move requires split-second timing and accuracy, and it felt incredible to execute it perfectly with my partner and the crowds cheering. After the final match, we anxiously waited for the rankings to be finalized. When the first alliance captain called our team as their second pick, excitement rushed through me. I was ready to



Amogh Rao (sr.) and Ved Patel (sr.) setting up our robot before a match.

see *Driver Life at the Capital City Classic*, page 4

Miller Robotics

Olivia Yuen (sr.)

Walking into a Miller Middle School classroom full of students chattering and ready to learn gave me a feeling of excitement. Giving kids the opportunity to get hands-on experience with robotics is how our team prepares these potential members for the future. At Miller Robotics, our lessons cover a variety of topics like motors, sensors, software, gears, and much more. We also incorporate challenges, such as having the robot navigate through difficult mazes, into our lessons. Students not only learn about technical concepts but also how to work as a team and collaborate to

come up with creative and unique ideas.

The students learn a lot, and so do the mentors. Mentors have the chance to practice leadership and problem solving, as well as social skills.

*I saw eyes looking with
interest and fascination*

I still vividly remember one of my first sessions as a mentor. As I stood at the front of the classroom presenting on various types of sensors, I saw eyes looking with interest and fascination. After I explained the challenge of the session, the groups dispersed to get their EV3 kits labeled with their funny group names. I heard the groups excitedly sharing their

immediate ideas: “Which sensors should we use?”, “How should our code look?”, “What fun creations can we make?”

Miller Robotics has taught me a variety of skills, such as problem solving and leadership. I have also made fun memories with the students there and truly enjoyed working with them to overcome challenges. Moments like these are what makes me interested in spreading knowledge in our community. Team 846 is full of fun activities such as our teaching programs, our YouTube channel "Monkey Box", and our demonstrations of our robot at local schools. Seeing the community around me grow with me is what I love the most about robotics. 🤖

The Western Region Robotics Forum, Continued...

Despite having no prior knowledge, we signed up with the intention of putting ourselves outside of our comfort zones. We were eager to involve ourselves within the robotics team and connect with other members. After much contemplation, we selected the topic that interested us the most: sensors and electronics.

We fully immersed ourselves in our preparation. Rather than relying on videos, we decided to challenge ourselves with live demonstrations. It was ambitious and overwhelming, yet we were fueled by excitement. Over three intense days, we prepared our live demonstration using an oscilloscope (a device measuring voltage over time), a breadboard (similar to a circuit board), and motors. Each challenge we overcame boosted our confidence and motivated us to push ourselves even harder. Feedback from our mentors and our teammates refined our delivery. After countless hours of commitment, the moment came to

showcase our week's worth of dedication.

The morning of WRRF, we were looking forward to presenting. At the same time, there are no words to describe just how nervous we were. With little time to worry, we packed our demo supplies—a hall effect sensor, oscilloscope, and a few motors—into the car and hurried to Santa Clara University.



**Rhea Susarla (jr.) and
Allison Chew (jr.)
presenting at WRRF.**

After checking in, we attended the first presentation on the schedule: our own team's electrical and pneumatics presentation. As we sat in the audience and listened in, we

realized that it was helpful to see a preview of how the presentation might go.

While not every detail from the first few minutes of our presentation is clear, the thirty people we faced suddenly seemed like a lot more than it had before, when we were simply listening as audience members. We presented exactly as we practiced: following cues, alternating parts, and explaining our demos. Presenting was not nearly as intimidating as we had thought, and we were content with how we delivered our presentation.

Ultimately, presenting at WRRF was an invaluable opportunity. The experience was stressful and, at times, exhausting, yet it was incredibly rewarding in the end. For any rookies looking to get into Lynbrook Robotics, we highly recommend participating in WRRF—whether to deepen your involvement in robotics, challenge yourself, or simply enjoy the process. 🤖

Driver Life at the Capital City Classic, Continued...

give everything I had in the elimination matches.

The elimination rounds were intense. Every match demanded a combination of skill, strategy, and nerves of steel. I felt the pressure, but I also felt confident. My team trusted me, and I trusted the robot we had built together. Our alliance steamrolled our way through the competition and arrived at the finals. In the finals, every team brought their A-game. It was a battle of coordination and persistence, with matches coming down to just a few points. When the second final match ended, and we realized we had won, it was pure joy. Driving the robot that helped our alliance claim the win was an unforgettable experience.

As the competition came to a close, I could not help but reflect on how far we had come as a team. From nervously driving my first match at Sunset Showdown, to standing on the finals stage at the Capital City Classic, every setback, every hour, and the countless efforts our team endured had built towards this moment. This victory was not just a personal one, it was proof of the teamwork, resilience, and growth that our team experienced together. 🤖

Vyaas's Welcome, Continued...



Vyaas Baskar (sr.) presenting our design highlights to judges during Sunset Showdown 2024.

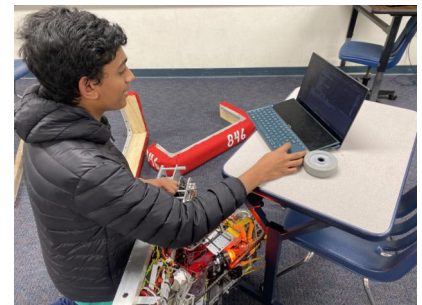
year, I was amazed by the variety of projects new members could jump into. Be a part of our business group that fundraises each year so we can build a ~\$15,000 robot. Join Monkey Box and create videos sharing our experience with thousands of viewers. Create graphics for our widely known Funky Monkey branding. Learn to fabricate complex metal parts on CNCs. Use CAD software to design our truly one-of-a-kind robot. Or, like I did, join the software team and create innovative features and cool acronyms for those features.

One competition at a time, we learned from our successes and failures to create *THE* most eye-catching robot on the field. From dominating the lower bracket at Canada, to our infinitesimally close,

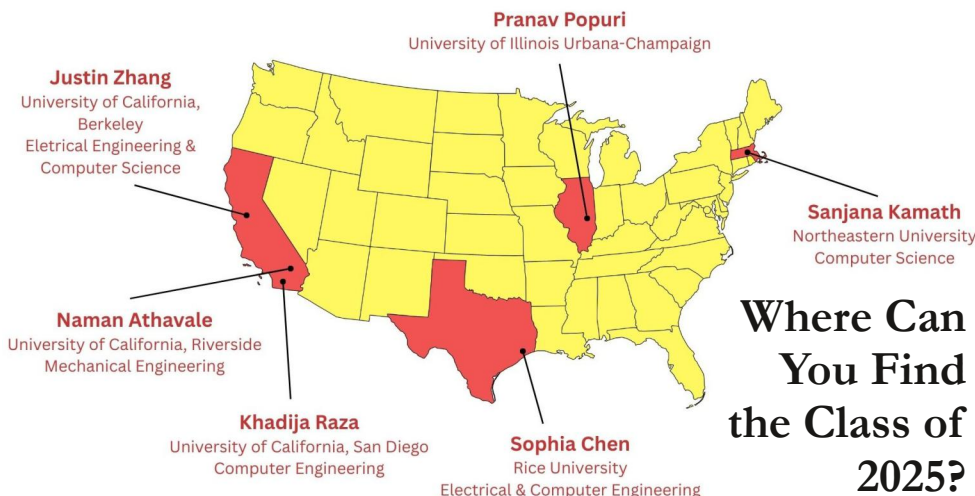
near-win against formidable opponents at the Aerospace Valley Regional, and an eventual victory at the Northern California Invitational, our crazy and unorthodox ideas were the reason we made it so far.

One team dinner at a time, we grew closer. Discussing ideas, odd hypotheticals, or just anything over Domino's pizza and boba tea, we grew into a tight-knit community and a close group of friends.

It might seem daunting at first but I assure you, no matter your interest or initial experience, you will find your place on the Funky Monkeys and have a wild time. I can't wait to have a championship winning season with you all!



Vyaas Baskar (sr.) writing code for our robot.



Where Can You Find the Class of 2025?

Fall Workshops

Media/Animation (Mon): 4:00 - 6:00

Machining (Tue): 4:00 - 6:00

Design (Wed): 3:15 - 5:15

Software (Thur): 4:00 - 6:00

Electrical/Assembly (Fri): 3:15 - 5:15

Weekly Fall Workshop Schedule Starting the Week of 9/22

Graphic by Brian Rong